

Fat Loss

12-Week Concurrent Block

Flagship · Intermediate · Gym · 6 days per week

- Concurrent training: 4 lifting days, 2 conditioning days, 1 walk
- Preservation volume — Renaissance Periodization Minimum Effective range
- Two programmed deload weeks (Week 5 and Week 9)
- Weekly refeed from Week 5 to protect metabolic rate

Concurrent training program engineered to strip bodyfat while preserving lean mass. Four lifting sessions retain strength and muscle through a caloric deficit; two conditioning sessions create the metabolic environment for fat oxidation; one long walk caps the weekly energy expenditure. Twelve weeks, two programmed deloads, a deliberate intensity taper at the end. Built for the lifter who wants to keep what they've built — and lose what they don't want.

Program Overview

Field	Detail
Goal	Drop 6 to 12 pounds of bodyfat in 12 weeks while preserving 95% or more of current lean mass. Visible abdominal definition by Week 12 for lifters starting under 20% bodyfat.
Who it is for	Intermediate lifter (at least one year of consistent training) carrying 14 to 25 percent bodyfat, with full gym access and the willingness to track food intake. Five to six training sessions per week, 50 to 75 minutes each.
Who it is not for	Beginners with under one year of training (build the engine first). Anyone under 12 percent bodyfat (use Aesthetic Photoshoot Peak instead). Anyone unwilling to track calories or weigh food.
Equipment	Full commercial gym — barbell, dumbbells, bench, squat rack, cable station, pull-up bar, leg press, rowing machine, stationary bike or assault bike, treadmill.
Split	Upper / Lower / Push / Pull lifting + two conditioning days + one long walk day. Six training days, one rest day.
Periodization	Template Tier 3 — eight-week fat loss concurrent block followed by a four-week intensification and refeed taper. Deloads at Week 5 and Week 9.

Weekly Volume Curve

Hard sets per muscle per week — held intentionally low compared to a hypertrophy block. The goal is to **preserve** muscle while in a deficit, not to push for growth. Pushing volume in a deficit is the fastest way to lose strength and lean mass.

Week	Phase	Chest	Back	Quads	Hamstrings	Side Delts	Biceps	Triceps	Glutes	RPE Cap
1	Preservation	10	12	10	8	10	6	6	8	7
2	Preservation	10	12	10	8	10	6	6	8	7

Week	Phase	Chest	Back	Quads	Hamstrings	Side Delts	Biceps	Triceps	Glutes	RPE Cap
3	Preservation	12	14	12	10	12	8	8	10	8
4	Preservation	12	14	12	10	12	8	8	10	8
5	Deload	6	7	6	5	6	4	4	5	6
6	Preservation	12	14	12	10	12	8	8	10	8
7	Intensification	10	12	10	8	10	6	6	8	8.5
8	Intensification	10	12	10	8	10	6	6	8	9
9	Deload	6	7	6	5	6	4	4	5	6
10	Intensification	10	12	10	8	10	6	6	8	9
11	Intensification	8	10	8	6	8	5	5	6	9
12	Taper / Photos	6	8	6	5	6	4	4	5	7

Conditioning volume runs parallel: two cardio sessions per week starting at 25 minutes (Week 1) and climbing to 40 minutes (Week 11), one Zone 2 and one high-intensity. Plus one 60 to 90 minute walk on the weekend.

Week 1 — Foundation

Rate of Perceived Exertion is capped at 7 on every working set. Caloric deficit is locked in at 400 to 500 below maintenance. The lifting weight should feel roughly what you used last week before starting this program — do not chase loads in a deficit. The goal of every lifting session is to give the body a reason to keep its muscle.

Day 1 — Upper Body Lift · 65 minutes

Warm-up: 5 minutes easy row · band pull-aparts 2 sets of 15 · band shoulder dislocates 2 sets of 10 · empty-bar bench press 2 sets of 8.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
1	Barbell Bench Press	3 × 6 to 8	RPE 7	3 minutes	7	Pause one second on chest each rep.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
2	Weighted Pull-up (or Lat Pulldown)	3 × 6 to 8	RPE 7	3 minutes	7	Full hang at bottom.
3	Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press	3 × 8 to 10	RPE 7	2 minutes	7	Stop at forehead. Do not lock out.
4	Chest-Supported Dumbbell Row	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	2 minutes	8	Elbow path at 45 degrees.
5	Cable Lateral Raise	2 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	75 seconds	8	Lean away. Lead with the elbow.
6	Cable Triceps Pushdown	2 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Rope. Full lockout.
7	Incline Dumbbell Curl	2 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Full stretch at the bottom.

Cool-down: doorway pec stretch 30 seconds per side for two rounds.

Day 2 — Conditioning · Zone 2 · 30 minutes

Protocol: 30 minutes of steady-state cardio at a pace where you can hold a conversation but it is mildly inconvenient. Heart rate between 60 and 70 percent of maximum. Use the rowing machine, stationary bike, or treadmill at an incline of 8 to 10 percent.

#	Block	Duration	Intensity	Notes
1	Warm-up	5 minutes	Easy	Bring heart rate up gradually.
2	Steady Zone 2	20 minutes	60–70% max heart rate	Nose breathing if you can sustain it.
3	Cool-down	5 minutes	Easy	Walk it out. Hydrate.

Coach note: Zone 2 trains the mitochondrial machinery that oxidizes fat. It is boring and effective. Do not turn it into a hard workout.

Day 3 — Lower Body Lift · 70 minutes

Warm-up: 5 minutes easy bike · hip circles · leg swings · bodyweight squats 2 sets of 10 · empty-bar back squat 2 sets of 5.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
1	Barbell Back Squat	3 × 5 to 7	RPE 7	3 minutes	7	Hit depth. Brace hard.
2	Romanian Deadlift	3 × 8 to 10	RPE 7	2 minutes	7	Push hips back. Neutral spine.
3	Leg Press (high foot position)	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	2 minutes	8	Knees track over toes.
4	Lying Leg Curl	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	75 seconds	8	Two-second eccentric.
5	Barbell Hip Thrust	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	90 seconds	8	Pause one second at top.
6	Standing Calf Raise	3 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Full stretch. One-second pause.
7	Hanging Leg Raise	3 × 10 to 12	Bodyweight	60 seconds	8	Slow controlled lower.

Day 4 — Push (lighter, higher rep) · 55 minutes

Warm-up: 5 minutes easy bike · band pull-aparts · empty-bar overhead press 2 sets of 8.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
1	Incline Dumbbell Press	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	2 minutes	8	30-degree bench.
2	Standing Overhead Press	3 × 8 to 10	RPE 8	2 minutes	8	Glutes tight. No leg drive.
3	Cable Chest Fly	3 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	75 seconds	8	Slight forward step. Squeeze.
4	Dumbbell Lateral Raise	3 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Slight forward lean.
5	Overhead Dumbbell Triceps Extension	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Single dumbbell, two hands.
6	Rope Triceps Pushdown	2 × 12 to 15	RPE 9	60 seconds	9	Drop set last set if energy allows.

Day 5 — Conditioning · Intervals · 25 minutes

Protocol: Eight rounds of high-intensity work with recovery between. Use the assault bike, rowing machine, or hill sprints on a treadmill. The work intervals should leave you unable to speak.

#	Block	Duration	Intensity	Notes
1	Warm-up	5 minutes	Easy	Build to a brisk pace.
2	Round 1 work	30 seconds	Hard (RPE 9)	All out without losing form.
3	Round 1 recovery	90 seconds	Easy	Active recovery, do not stop.
4	Rounds 2 through 8	14 minutes total	Same pattern	Eight rounds total.
5	Cool-down	5 minutes	Easy	Walk or pedal slowly.

Coach note: Two conditioning sessions per week is the dose-response sweet spot. Adding more is what tanks lifting performance in a deficit.

Day 6 — Pull · 60 minutes

Warm-up: 5 minutes easy row · scapular pull-ups 2 sets of 8 · band face pulls 2 sets of 15.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
1	Conventional Deadlift	3 × 5	RPE 7	3 minutes	7	Reset each rep. Form over load.
2	Barbell Row (Pendlay or T-Bar)	3 × 8 to 10	RPE 7	2 minutes	7	Pull to lower sternum.
3	Lat Pulldown (wide pronated)	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	2 minutes	8	Drive elbows down. No lean back.
4	Seated Cable Row (close grip)	3 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	90 seconds	8	Squeeze shoulder blades.
5	Cable Face Pull	3 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	High elbows. External rotation.
6	Hammer Curl	2 × 10 to 12	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Slow two-second eccentric.

#	Exercise	Sets × Reps	Load	Rest	RPE	Notes
7	Cable Crunch	3 × 12 to 15	RPE 8	60 seconds	8	Round upper back. Squeeze hard.

Day 7 — Long Walk · 60 to 90 minutes

Outdoor walk at a conversational pace. Not on a treadmill. Not with a phone in your hand the whole time. This is recovery, low-stress fat burn, and a mental reset. Aim for 8,000 to 12,000 steps. If the weather is bad, bike or row at a very easy pace for 60 minutes instead.

Progression Rules — Weeks 2 through 12

Hold loads, do not chase them. In a deficit, the goal is to keep what you have, not add. If you can match last week's weight for the same reps with crisp form, that is a win — your body recomposed.

Conditioning progression. Add one minute to the Zone 2 session every week through Week 8. Hold at 40 minutes from Week 9 onward. The interval session adds one round every two weeks, from 8 rounds (Weeks 1–2) to 12 rounds (Weeks 11–12).

Lifting volume. Held flat through Weeks 1 to 4, dropped 40 percent for the Week 5 deload, restored at Week 6, then trimmed gradually through Weeks 7 to 11 as intensity climbs. Volume comes down, intensity goes up — the classic deficit strategy.

RPE progression. Weeks 1 to 4 capped at 7 on main lifts and 8 on isolations. Weeks 6 to 8 capped at 8 on mains. Weeks 10 to 12 capped at 9 on mains. The Week 12 photo week is a taper at RPE 7.

Refeeds. One refeed day per week starting in Week 5 — eat at maintenance, push carbs to 4 to 5 grams per kilogram bodyweight, drop fat to under 50 grams. This restores leptin, replenishes glycogen, and improves the next week's training.

Deload weeks (5 and 9). Working sets halved. RPE capped at 6. Conditioning halved in duration. No interval work. Calories held at deficit but consider a diet break to maintenance for the seven days — this is well-supported in the research for preserving metabolic rate.

Two-week scale stall. If the scale has not moved down for two consecutive weeks, drop daily calories by another 150 to 200. Do not add cardio first. Always cut food before adding work.

Why This Works

Fat loss is a math problem with biology constraints. The math is a sustained caloric deficit. The biology is preserving the lean mass that drives your metabolic rate and gives you the physique you actually want to see at the end.

Four lifting days at preservation volume (Renaissance Periodization Minimum Effective Volume range) signals your body to keep its muscle through the deficit. Cutting lifting volume below Minimum Effective is the single most common mistake in fat loss programs — you lose strength, you lose muscle, and your finished physique looks worse than your

starting one.

Two conditioning sessions split between Zone 2 and high-intensity intervals cover both ends of the metabolic spectrum: mitochondrial density and VO2 max ceiling. Three or more cardio sessions per week starts to interfere with strength training recovery — the so-called interference effect — which is why this program caps at two structured cardio days plus one walk.

The deload weeks are non-negotiable. Twelve weeks in a deficit is a long time to be under-recovered. The two deload weeks in this program let your central nervous system and connective tissue recover. Skip them and you will hit Week 8 stalled, irritable, and injured.

Expected Results

If you hit at least 85 percent of sessions, track food intake daily, and average 7,000+ steps per day outside of training:

- Six to twelve pounds of scale weight loss — roughly 90 to 95 percent of which is fat mass.
- Loss of one to two pant sizes for most lifters.
- Visible abdominal definition by Week 12 if starting under 20 percent bodyfat.
- Strength preserved at 90 to 95 percent of starting numbers on the main lifts.
- Visible conditioning improvement — resting heart rate down 5 to 10 beats per minute, perceived exertion at any given pace lower.

What this program will **not** do: deliver fast fat loss. The aggressive cuts that drop 20 pounds in 8 weeks cost lean mass and rebound. This is the slower, smarter version.

Evidence

The prescriptions in this program are anchored to peer-reviewed research and evidence-based coaching resources.

Source	Topic	Reference
Helms et al. 2014	Evidence-based recommendations for natural bodybuilding contest preparation.	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24864135
Aragon and Schoenfeld 2013	Nutrient timing revisited — is there a post-exercise anabolic window.	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/23360586
Helms et al. 2016	Rate of Perceived Exertion in resistance training prescription.	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/27328853
Trexler et al. 2014	Metabolic adaptation to weight loss — implications for the athlete.	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24571926
Schoenfeld 2017	Volume dose-response for hypertrophy (preserved volume = preserved muscle).	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/27433992

Source	Topic	Reference
Wilson et al. 2012	Concurrent training meta-analysis — the interference effect.	pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/22002517

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